

DAY 1: YOUR FIRST DAY ON THE JOB

LAB CHECKLIST: BUILD NMG.COM DOMAIN

PREREQUISITES CHECK

- ☒ Computer has at least 8GB RAM available
 - ☒ At least 40GB free storage space
 - ☒ Internet connection (for downloads)
 - ☒ Administrative access on your computer
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PHASE 1: SETUP

You're about to build a "pretend computer" (a virtual machine) and install Windows Server on it. The tool that builds that pretend computer is called a hypervisor, and which one you use depends on your machine. **Find your group below and follow only that section.** The setup is the one part that looks different between machines. The moment Windows Server starts installing, every screen is identical for everyone and we finish together.

- **Apple chip (M1, M2, M3, M4 Mac)?** → Follow the 🍏 section.
 - **Windows PC, Intel Mac, or Linux?** → Follow the 💻 section.
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🍏 APPLE SILICON USERS (Mac with M1, M2, M3, or M4 chip)

- ☒ Download and install **UTM** (free): <https://mac.getutm.app/>
- ☒ Download the **ARM Windows Server ISO** from this link: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1hpmhxgqwbgvV2LfLMIOQOKZYP2wcMPz0/view?usp=drive-link>. Leave the file in your Downloads folder. Do not open or install it.
- ☒ In UTM, click **+**, then choose **Virtualize** (not Emulate), then **Windows**.
- ☒ Keep or Set **RAM to 4GB (4096 MB)** and leave CPU cores at default
- ☒ Keep **"Install drivers and SPICE tools"** checked. Click **Browse** and select the ISO from Downloads.
- ☒ Set **storage to 40GB**. Name it **NMG-DC01**.
- ☒ Start the VM. When you see **"Press any key to boot from CD/DVD,"** click into the window and press a key quickly. (Mouse stuck? Press **Control + Option** to release it.)

- ☒ During install, click "**I don't have a product key,**" and click continue
 - ☒ The VM will reboot multiple times. Do not panic. No need to do anything
 - ☒ Type a password and retype it.
 - ☒ Login with the new password
 - ☐
 - ☒ Run **ipconfig**, note your IP / subnet Mask / gateway,
 - ☒ Set a **static IP** inside that same range you noted.
 - ☒ Open the **Control Panel** and navigate to **Network and Sharing Center**.
 - ☒ Click **Change adapter settings** in the left sidebar.
 - ☒ Right-click your network adapter (usually labeled *Ethernet*) and select **Properties**.
 - ☒ Double-click on **Internet Protocol Version 4 (TCP/IPv4)**.
 - ☒ Select **Use the following IP address** and enter your the previous IP, Subnet mask, and Default gateway you noted.
 - ☒ **Verify with a browser, not ping.** On UTM, **ping** fails sometimes even when the internet works. Open Edge and load a webpage to confirm you're connected.
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WINDOWS, INTEL MAC, OR LINUX USERS (no Apple chip)

- ☐ Download and install **VirtualBox** (free): <https://www.virtualbox.org/wiki/Downloads>
- ☐ Download the **64-bit Windows Server ISO** (2019 or 2022) from Microsoft's Eval Center: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/evalcenter/download-windows-server-2019>. Leave the file in your Downloads folder. Do not open or install it.
- ☐ In VirtualBox, click **New**. Name it **NMG-DC01**. Set Type to **Microsoft Windows** and Version to **Windows 2019/2022 (64-bit)**. Point the ISO field to the file in Downloads.
- ☐ Set **RAM to 4GB (4096 MB)**, set **CPUs to 2**, and create a virtual hard disk with **40GB storage**.
- ☐ Open the VM's **Settings > Network > Adapter 1**, set "**Attached to: Bridged Adapter**", then save. (On a VPN or locked-down work/Wi-Fi network and it won't connect? Switch this to **NAT** instead.)
- ☐ Start the VM. When you see "**Press any key to boot from CD/DVD,**" click into the window and press a key quickly. (Mouse stuck? Press the **Host key**, default **Right Ctrl**, to release it.)
- ☐ During install, click "**I don't have a product key,**" then choose **Standard (Desktop Experience)**. The "Desktop Experience" wording is required, it gives you the clickable desktop.
- ☐ After install, install **Guest Additions**: in the VM's top menu click **Devices > Insert Guest Additions CD image**, then open **File Explorer > This PC**, open the new **CD drive**, run the **.exe installer**, and reboot. This fixes mouse, display, and clipboard.

- ☐ Run **ipconfig**, note your IP / subnet / gateway, then set a **static IP** inside that same range.
 - ☐ **Verify connectivity.** On Bridged networking, **ping your host computer's IP works**, so use that. (If you switched to NAT, open a browser and load a webpage instead.)
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☒ **Everyone reunites here.** Once Windows Server is installed and you've confirmed it's connected, you've finished Phase 1. The rest of the lab looks the same on every machine.

PHASE 2: ACTIVE DIRECTORY & DOMAIN CONTROLLER

- ☐ Open Server Manager (starts automatically on first login)
 - ☐ Install Active Directory Domain Services role
 - ☐ Click "Add Roles and Features"
 - ☐ Select "Active Directory Domain Services"
 - ☐ Complete the installation
 - ☐ Promote this server to a Domain Controller
 - ☐ Click the flag icon in Server Manager (notification area)
 - ☐ Select "Promote this server to a domain controller"
 - ☐ Choose "Add a new forest"
 - ☐ Enter domain name: NMG.com
 - ☐ Set Directory Services Restore Mode (DSRM) password (write this down)
 - ☐ Complete the promotion (server will restart)
 - ☐ Log back in using NMG\Administrator (with your password)
 - ☐ Verify Active Directory is running
 - ☐ Open Active Directory Users and Computers
 - ☐ Confirm you can see NMG.com in the tree
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PHASE 3: DOCUMENTATION & PROOF

- ☐ Take a screenshot showing Active Directory Users and Computers with NMG.com visible
- ☐ Take a screenshot of Server Manager showing Active Directory Domain Services as installed
- ☐ Open Command Prompt and run: dcdiag
- ☐ Take a screenshot of the dcdiag results (shows domain controller health)
- ☐ Create a text file with the following information and save it:
 - ☐ Domain name: NMG.com
 - ☐ Domain Controller name: (your VM's computer name)

- ☐ Static IP: (the IP you assigned)
 - ☐ Date completed: (today's date)
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COMPLETION CHECK

Before you move on, verify you have:

- ☐ A functioning Windows Server VM with 4GB RAM and 40GB storage
 - ☐ Active Directory installed and running
 - ☐ NMG.com domain created and operational
 - ☐ Domain Controller promoted successfully
 - ☐ Screenshots saved showing AD Users and Computers with NMG.com visible
 - ☐ Documentation saved with domain details
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<https://www.skool.com/totalthreat-free>